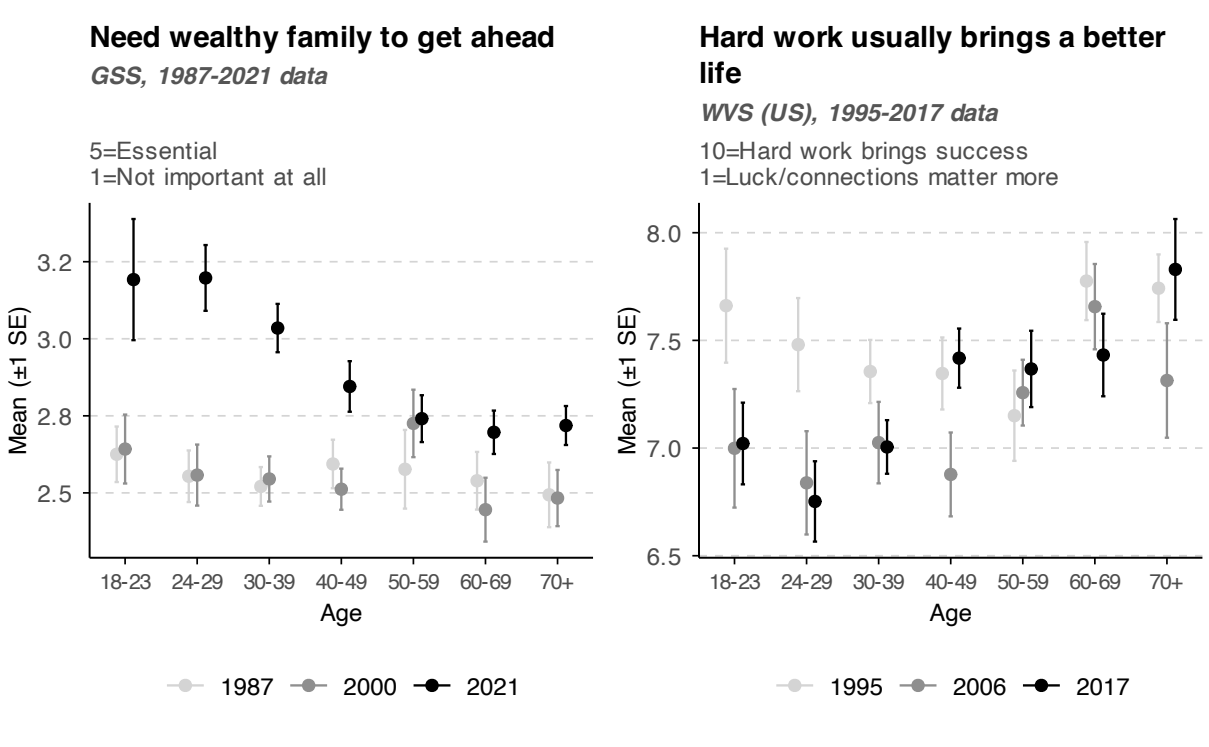
Need wealthy family to get ahead
GSS, 1987-2021 data
5=Essential
1=Not important at all
Mean (±1 SE)
3.2
3.0
2.8
2.5
18-23
24-29
30-39
40-49
50-59
60-69
70+
Age
1987
2000
2021
Hard work usually brings a better life
WVS (US), 1995-2017 data
10=Hard work brings success
1=Luck/connections matter more
Mean (±1 SE)
8.0
7.5
7.0
6.5
18-23
24-29
30-39
40-49
50-59
60-69
70+
Age
1995
2006
2017